

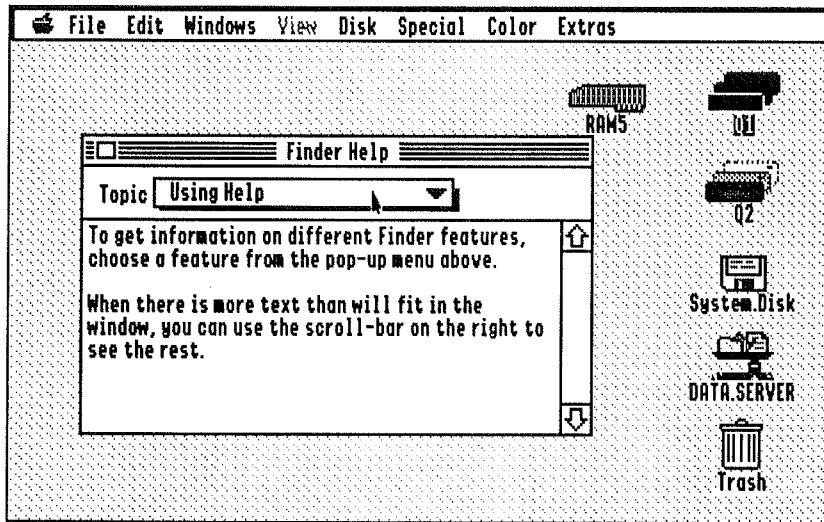


Figure 5K—Sample Pop-Up Menu (Help, from Finder)

Text Fields

Line-Edit Fields

You’ve already been introduced to line-edit fields if you read the section on dialogs above. Line-edit fields are used to fill in text data (such as the name of the disk in the Initialize dialog) that your computer needs to complete a task. Since they’re text-edit fields, you enter data into them by typing. We’ve already discussed how to move from one line-edit field to another using the Tab key (see the “Shortcut” in “Using Dialogs” above).

Text-Edit Fields

Text-edit fields are the multi-line equivalent of line-edit fields. Instead of being limited to a single line of text, you can enter many lines—practically as many as you want, though there’s usually some limit. As with list fields, you’ll often see scroll arrows to allow you to move through a long text-edit entry.

The Finder’s “Comment” card (in the Icon Info window) is a typical text-edit field (although it doesn’t have scroll arrows). Most word processors are based on the conventions of text-edit fields—the window containing your document is considered one big text-edit field.

Both line-edit and text-edit fields react to the same kinds of mouse and keyboard actions, so we’re covering them together. Of course, you’re limited to a single line of text in line-edit fields.